

Public Information About the Characters Involved

(there will be name tags!)

The part of each person's name usually used in speech is in all caps. To be polite use title + surname

Cardinals Declared *Papabile* (i.e. active candidates for the papacy):

1. **Rodrigo BORGIA.** (Boar-jah) Age 61, Spanish, Noble. Nephew of a long-dead pope, has lived in Rome since youth, and for 20 years has been Vice-Chancellor, the pope's second in command and head of Papal administration/finance. Competent, friendless and ruthless.
2. **Oliviero CARAFA.** (Car-rah-fuh) Age 62, from Naples, Noble. Head of the Dominican Order, related to St. Thomas Aquinas, ties to Rodrigo Borgia & Ferdinand of Aragon.
3. **Giovanni COLONNA.** (Coe-low-nuh) Age 57, Roman, Noble. Descended from Caesar's generals. Beloved of the Roman Mob. Leader of the Ghibelline party, enemy of the Orsini.
4. **Francesco "SAMSON" Nanni.** Age 78, Siena, Noble. Pious, zealous, physically imposing, head of the Franciscans, an order focused on poverty & love. Pro-crusade. Ghibelline.
5. **Giambattista ORSINI.** (Or-see-nee) Age 57, Roman, Noble. Descended from Caesar's generals. Beloved of Roman Mob. Leader of the Guelph party, bitter enemy of the Colonna.
6. **Francesco Todeschini PICCOLOMINI.** (Pea-coal-low-me-nee) Age 63, Siena, Noble. Scholar, nephew of past pope, brother of Duke of Amalfi, other brother runs Siena. Ghibelline.
7. **"Julius" Giuliano DELLA ROVERE.** (del-luh Row-ver-ray) 49, Savona (Genoa), Noble. Franciscan. Heir of Sixtus IV, skilled statesman just back from France, brother is Duke of Sora.
8. **Ascanio Visconti SFORZA.** (Svor-tseh) Age 41, Milan, High Noble. Savvy warrior. The Sforza conquered Milan only 50 years ago. Ascanio recently helped his brother Ludovico seize the throne from their nephew Gian Galeazzo. France is threatening to invade Milan. Ghibelline.
9. **INQUISITOR GENERAL Gioacchino Torriani.** Age 60, Milan, Noble. Pious, zealous, in charge of Inquisition & heresy-hunting. Dominicans favor truth & scholarship. Guelph.

Beginning the simulation declared *papabile* does not necessarily mean a character is trying for the throne, or more important than other Cardinals. The Vice-Chancellor, the Orsini & Colonna, and heads of major monastic orders are *papabile* by tradition, whether or not they want to be pope.

Senior Cardinals not (yet) Declared *Papabile*, but who could be:

10. **Pierre D'AUBUSSON.** (Dow-boo-son, but the N is silent) Age 69, French, Noble. Grand Master of the Knights Hospitaller, crusader knight, zealous enemy of the Ottoman Empire.
11. **Guillaume BRIÇONNET.** (Bree-sown-neigh) Age 47, French, Noble. King Charles's chief general, adviser, & right-hand man, the architect of the French invasion which threatens Milan.
12. **Paolo CAMPOFREGOSO.** (Freh-go-so) 62, Genoese, noble. Family long dominated Genoa but undone by internal family betrayals. Admiral, pirate, 3x Doge of Genoa, overthrown, exiled.
13. **Jorge DA COSTA.** (Dah Cost-uh) Age 86, Portuguese, commoner who worked his way up from poverty on pure merit, banished by King *Joaô* but possibly still serving him? Brilliant.
14. **Maffeo Gherardi, THE PATRIARCH of Venice.** Age 97, Venetian, Noble. Head of the semi-independent Church of Venice. Ancient, senile, fading fast. Benedictine monk.
15. **Giovanni "ACHILLES" Antonio Sangiorgio.** Age 53, Milanese, noble, famous canon law expert, once Sforza ambassador to Hungary, Postulator General in charge of canonizing new saints. Nickname from his legal skills & his home church: Church of Ss. Neres & Achilles.
16. **Francesco SODERINI.** (Saw-deh-ree-nee) Age 51, Florentine, Commoner. Bitter enemy of the Medici. Scholar and lover of the classics. Guelph.
17. **Giovanni BATTISTA ZEN.** Age 53, Venetian nobility, nephew of a dead pope, corruptly appointed, rarely leaves Venice so little is known about him.

Cardinals too young to be *Papabile*:

18. **Pietro BEMBO**. (Bem-bo) Age 22, Noble. Humanist, son of the famous Venetian scholar-knight Bernardo Bembo. Della Rovere's influence helped him become a Cardinal so young.
19. **Michel DE BUCY**. (Deh Boo-see) Age 21, French, High Noble. King Charles's bastard cousin, a trusted favorite of the Crown. Charming, princely, haughty, playful, foppish. Very French.
20. **Adriano "HADRIAN" Castellesi**. (Hay-dree-en) Age 32, born near Rome, papal ambassador to England. Too young to have made much of a mark yet.
21. **Ippolito D'ESTE**. (Deh Es-stay) age 22, from Ferrara, High Noble. Benedictine. From the noblest family in Italy, brother of Duke Alfonso d'Este of Ferrara, nephew of Queen Beatrice of Hungary, grandson of Ferrante of Naples. Virtuous, jovial, ally of HRE and Venice.
22. **"Leo" Giovanni DE MEDICI**. (De Meh-dih-chee) Age 17, Florentine, Commoner. The Medici bankers are the wealthiest non-royal family in Europe, merchant scum bit with vast resources, including artists and scholars. Currently Papal banker. Guelph.
23. Papal Camerlengo **Raffaele RIARIO**. (Ree-are-ree-oh) Age 31, Noble (newish), Savona (Genoa), made cardinal scandalously young, nephew & heir of "Julius" Giuliano Della Rovere. Fond of art. Was party to the Pazzi conspiracy, saved from the mob by Lorenzo de Medici.
24. **Federico (da Montefeltro) SANSEVERINO**. (San-sever-reno) Age 18, Noble. Benedictine from near Naples, son of famous mercenary, related to many Ghibelline families, nephew of Cardinals Carafa, Colonna, della Rovere, Fregoso, Sforza, + the Duke of Urbino & Malatestas.
25. **Matthäus SCHINER**. (Shine-er) Age 35, Swiss, Noble. First Cardinal from Switzerland, veteran mercenary captain with armies for hire, official papal legate to the HRE.

Non-Cardinal Functionaries Within the Sistine LISTED IN ORDER OF RANK:

26. Treasurer: **Cesare "VALENTINO" Borgia**, Bishop of Valencia. (Val-len-tee-no) Age 17, Spanish-Roman, Nobility) Illegitimate son of Cardinal Borgia, born in Rome. Helps manage the Papal Treasury, and the Vatican paperwork. Hot-tempered and often involved in brawls.
27. Papal Chaplain **Alessandro FARNESE**. (Far-nay-zay) Age 18, Roman, Noble. Pretty-boy from a noble but impoverished Roman family. Some influence over the Roman Mob.
28. Papal Guard **CAPTAIN Micheletto Corella**. Age 22, Spanish, physically intimidating.
29. Chief Secretary: **Gherardo MAFFEI** (Je-rard-o Mah-fay), Age 71, commoner, from Volterra near Florence, has been the chief secretary for the last four popes, now planning to retire.
30. Master of Ceremonies **Father Johann BURCHARD** (Yo-hahn Burr-chard) Age 42: German bureaucrat in charge of logistics, preparing the papal raiment, taking notes at the ceremony, etc. Rumor has it he paid Pope Sixtus a 450 Florin bribe for this easy, high-paying job...
31. Choir Director: **JOSQUIN des Prez** (Jus-ken day Pray). Age 42, from Burgundy on the border of France and HRE, singer and perhaps the most celebrated composer in the world.
32. Clerk: **CONSTANTINE**. Age 33, Greek/Turkish. Minor noble. Refugee scholar from fallen Constantinople, well-educated, knows ancient Greek, from a Greek noble family.
33. Clerk: **Brother TILLIO**. (Tea-lee-oh) Age 21, Roman, commoner, Benedictine monk.

Monarchs and Outside Powers, IN ORDER OF POWER:

34. **EMPEROR Maximilian I (House of Hapsburg)** Age 41. Archduke of Austria by birth, Regent of Burgundy by marriage, Emperor by election. An Emperor must be crowned 3 times: he was crowned King of the Germans in Aachen, but must be crowned King of Lombardy by the Cardinal of Milan, then Emperor by the pope. Fought 2 wars against Vladoislaus of Hungary.

35. **CHARLES VIII, King of France, of the (House of Valois).** Age 22, Monarch. France is Europe's wealthiest nation, and its king the mightiest monarch. Charles was born sickly, but is politically daring and ambitious. He has a claim to the throne of Naples.
36. **ISABELLA I, Queen of Castile (House of Trastámara),** Queen-Consort of Aragon. Age 41, Castilian, Monarch. Famously pious and more powerful than her husband Ferdinand, she co-rules the united Spain, and since her heir Joanna married Maximilian's heir, her grandson little Carlos may inherit half of Europe. She & Ferdinand effectively control Naples.
37. **HENRY VII, King of ENGLAND, Scotland, & France, Lord of Ireland (House of Tudor).** Age 43, English-Welsh-French, Monarch. Savvy negotiator. Weak claim to England, which he took by force from Richard III. Has a claim to France, and holds a territory bordering Brittany (last remnant of the conquests of Henry V). Close ally of King João of Portugal.
38. **ANNE Duchess of Brittany & Queen of France (House of Montfort).** Age 19, Breton, Monarch. Brittany is an independent Duchy bordering France near England. Last year Anne married (by proxy) Emperor Maximilian, but was carried off by Charles of France who married her by force, and bribed the pope to approve it. She has borne one stillborn child.
39. **BEATRICE of Naples Twice Queen of Hungary, Queen of Bohemia (House of Trastámara).** Age 35. Cultured & educated daughter of King Ferrante of Naples, related to the d'Este and Orsini. First husband King Matthias Corvinus, died w/ no heir, and the bellicose King Vladislaus of Bohemia (son of Casimir of Poland) secured the crown by marrying her, though he was already married to Barbara of Brandenburg making the match bigamous.
40. **THE ROMAN MOB.** Age 2,252, Roman, Commoner. SPQR! RAAAAAAA!

Other non-player historical figures who will be involved through letters &c. include...

- **King Ferdinand of Aragon** (Queen Isabella's husband, cunning & ambitious) & their reclusive heir Princess Joana.
- **King Ferrante of Naples** (old & mad), his wife Queen Joanna (Ferdinand's sister) & their heir Prince Alfonso of Naples.
- **King João of Portugal** & his book-loving wife Queen Leonor (just lost their only son).
- **King James of Scotland** (young, unwed).
- **King Vladislaus of Hungary & Bohemia** (bellicose, disowned for his warlike ways by his savvy father **King Casimir of Poland**).
- **Duchess Barbara of Brandenburg** (first wife of King Vladislaus, imprisoned).
- **Ottoman Sultan Bayezid** (rich & strong).
- **Sultan Cem** (pronounced "Jem" Bayezid's brother & rival, hostage in Rome).
- **Sultan Qa'it Bay of Egypt** (regaining strength after a war with the Ottomans).
- **Princess Anne of Beaujou** (former Regent of France & elder sister of King Charles).
- Claimants to the English throne including **Perkin Warbecc** aka. Richard son of Clarence, Countess Margaret Pole, & oddball astronomer **Baron Henry Clifford**.
- **Blanche of Montferrat**, Regent of Savoy, & other **Prince-Electors of the Empire**.
- **Duke Alfonso d'Este of Ferrara** (head of the most noble family in Italy, unwed).
- **Doge Barbarigo of Venice** (old, savvy).
- **Doge Adorno of Genoa** (greedy turncoat).
- **Duke Ludovico Visconti Sforza of Milan** (warrior), his **Duchess Beatrice D'Este**, & super sexy boyfriend **Galahad Sanseverino**.
- **Ex-Duke Gian Galeazzo Visconti Sforza of Milan** (overthrown by uncle), his wife **Isabella of Naples** (daughter of King Ferrante), & noble mother **Bona of Savoy**.
- **Duke Guidobaldo da Montefeltro of Urbino** (Ghibelline mercenary), his learned **Duchess Elizabetta Gonzaga**, & his brother-in-law **Francesco Gonzaga Marquess of Mantua** (mercenary, unwed).
- **Pandolfo Malatesta Lord of Rimini** (from a wild mercenary family, unmarried).
- **Giovanni Bentivoglio "First Citizen" of Bologna**, and his wife Ginevra Sforza.

- **Count Giovanni Pico della Mirandola** (brilliant scholar, excommunicated).
 - **Lorenzo de Medici of Florence** (cultured, unofficial ruler of the merchant republic).
 - **Dominican Friar Savonarola** (charismatic apocalyptic scholar-prophet, in Florence).
 - **Julia Farnese** (famous Roman adulteress).
- ...& many others.